

Confident Marks

Commitment, intention & the art of not second-guessing

The technical skills of drawing are only half the battle. The mental approach — committing to marks, tolerating imperfection, and drawing with intention — is what separates drawing that feels alive from drawing that feels timid.

KEY CONCEPTS

Commit and Move On

When a line is wrong, the instinct is to re-draw over it. Resist this. Acknowledge the mistake, note what went wrong, and move on. Over-working a bad line produces a messy, unconfident drawing. Draw through your mistakes.

Planning Before Executing

The ghosting method is essentially a planning discipline. Before any significant mark, plan it: Where does it start? Where does it end? What angle? What weight? The more deliberately you plan, the more confidently you can execute.

Embrace Imperfection

Perfect lines don't make great drawings — confident lines do. Some of the most powerful drawings in history have obvious 'mistakes'. What matters is intention and commitment. A slightly wrong confident line reads better than a 'correct' hesitant one.

Building the Habit

Confidence in mark-making is a habit built over thousands of marks, not a character trait you either have or don't. Every time you commit to a line instead of hedging, you build the neural pathway for the next one.

PRACTICE EXERCISES

1. Draw 100 lines without erasing any of them. Study what went wrong — don't fix it.
 2. Draw a face from reference in 2 minutes. No erasing, no re-drawing over lines.
 3. Keep a 'mark-making diary': one page per day of confident marks, no corrections.
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FURTHER READING

■ Proko – Confidence in Drawing

<https://youtu.be/AlmR-WKdi3c>

■ Drawing Basics – Commitment